

Glossary

Acceleration Change of speed – speeding up or slowing down.

Alpine Areas on a mountain side that are above the trees but below the permanent snow.

Alveoli Tiny air sacs inside your lungs.

Amphibian An animal that can live on land or in water.

Ancestor Someone you are related to who lived a long time ago.

Astronaut A person who is trained to travel into space.

Astronomy The study of the universe.

Atmosphere The thin layer of gas that surrounds a planet.

Bacterium (plural: bacteria) A living thing with just one cell. Bacteria are found all over the world – in the oceans, on land, in plants, and in our bodies.

Carnivore An animal that eats meat. Lions are carnivores.

Cell A tiny unit that is the basic building block of all living things.

Chlorophyll The chemical in plants that makes them green. It is essential for photosynthesis.

Chromosome A rod-shaped strand containing DNA, found in the nucleus of a cell.

Civilization The way of life of a group of people living in a particular area – ancient Greek civilization, for example.

Condensation Changing from a less dense state, such as a gas, into a more solid state, such as a liquid – for example, water vapour condenses into water.

Continent A large area of land, usually divided into different countries. Europe is a continent.

Decibel The unit of measurement for sound.

Deciduous A plant that loses many or all its leaves in one season each year. Oak and maple trees are deciduous.

Decomposition The breaking down (decaying) of dead animals and plants into smaller pieces, and recycling them into nutrients.

Dermis The deepest layer of skin, which contains nerves and blood vessels.

Diaphragm The muscle under your lungs that moves up and down as you breathe.

Digestion The system that breaks down and absorbs food so your body can use it for energy and to make new cells.

DNA A chemical inside your body that contains the instructions for making living cells.

Ecosystem A community of plants and animals living and interacting with each other and their immediate environment.

Epidermis The top layer of skin, which you can see.

Equator The imaginary line around the middle of the world.

Era A period of time in history.

Estuary The place where a river meets the sea.